

Canadian Government





About the Course

Students learn about the electoral process, the different aspects of parliamentary government, the Canadian legal system, and the concept of citizenship. They will spend the final term learning about the structure of our local and provincial authorities.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Canadian Government: Grade 7 1 time/week 25 min	Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Canadian Government: Grade 7

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and Plutarch, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway? and Citizenship Notebook

→ INTRO

How would you answer the question that is in the title of the book you will begin reading today? Who is in charge in Canada? How does our country make decisions? How does a law get made? What happens during an election? In this course, you will learn about the electoral process, the different aspects of parliamentary government, the Canadian legal system, and the concept of citizenship.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-6 "All week our classmates" - "in a moment." (Audiobook chapters 1-2)

→ NOTEBOOK

The Citizenship Notebook is an excellent place to keep track of definitions and to copy diagrams. If any of these terms are new to you, you may choose to include definitions in your notebook: democracy, municipal, federal, parliament, legislature, legislative, executive, judicial. As you read through the book this year, look for other terms that are new to you. The diagram on page 6 would also be a good one to add to your notebook.

★ TEACHER TIP

If you are using the audio recording of the book, the readings will correspond with the audiobook chapters (with timestamps, if necessary), and the recordings clearly denote the corresponding page numbers. Students can be encouraged to take notes as they listen to the audio recording.

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Senators, the Supreme Court, and the Prime Minister

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the three levels of government from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS OR NOTEBOOK

p.7-11 "When adults talk" - "by the government." (Audiobook chapter 3 0:00-8:49)

The following are points you can discuss with your parent or teacher, or write about in your citizenship notebook.

- Who are Senators, and what are the four important roles of the Senate?
- What is the role of the Supreme Court?
- What is the role of the Prime Minister? What kinds of appointments can he or she make?

→ VIEW

What do you think a Senator's day at Parliament Hill is like? Follow two of them around for a day to see what kind of work they do.

∞ Video Link: A Day in the Life of Senator Yonah Martin

∞ Video Link: A Day in the Life of Senator Dennis Glen Patterson

→ EXPLORE

Test your knowledge of who does what in the Senate.

∞ Link: Parliament at Work: Senate

• EXTRA HELPING

Have you ever wondered how and why Ottawa was chosen as Canada's capital city?

∞ Video Link: The Selection of Ottawa as the Capital of Canada



Term 1

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

More Government Positions and the British North America Act

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the various positions in Parliament?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.12-17 "If Nathan were the prime minister"- "strong as written laws!" (Audiobook: from chapter 3 at 8:50 to the end of chapter 4)

→ VIEW

1. Learn more about the role and duties of the Governor General.
∞ Video Link: What are the duties of Canada's governor general?
2. Learn more about the British North America Act.
∞ Video Link: The Words That Shaped Canada: The British North America Act

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 4

Confederation, The Constitution Act, and the Charter

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS OR NOTEBOOK

p.18-23 "Why mess with perfection?" - "equality of men and women." (Audiobook: Chapter 5)

Discuss these points with your parent/teacher, or make some notes in your citizenship notebook:

- What changes were made with the Constitution Act of 1982?
- What types of rights are guaranteed in the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms?

→ VIEW

1. Learn more about Canada's Constitution
∞ Video Link: What is the Canadian Constitution?
2. Test your knowledge of what rights and what freedoms are with an online activity.
∞ Link: Understanding Rights and Freedoms

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 5

Winners & Losers

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading about Canada's Constitution?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.24-27 "Some people are so keen" - "it all depends!" (Audiobook: Chapter 6)

→ NOTEBOOK

• COMPOSITION

Imagine you are going to start your own political party. What are some issues that matter the most to you? Define 3-5 foundational positions that your party would hold.



Term 1

- Choose one of the federal referendums on page 27 and create a pros/cons list of reasons why someone might vote for or against the question.
- Mark a few notable dates regarding the history of voting in Canada in your notebook, Timeline, or Book of Centuries.

WEEK 6 **25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 6** *Current Events - Government*

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 7 **25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 7** *Election Time*

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway? and Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last time about political parties and voting?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-31 "How will you" - "Congratulations!" (Audiobook: Chapter 7 0:00-6:09)

→ NOTEBOOK

What are some of the steps once an election is called? Add some notes to your Citizenship Notebook about today's reading, or a reading from a previous week.

WEEK 8 **25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 8** *Campaigns and Voters*

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last time about calling an election?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-35 "Are you ready" - "always had the vote." (Audiobook: chapter 7, 6:10-end)

- Looking at the timeline on page 35 (reproduced in Chapter 7 of the audio membership), determine when your province or territory first granted women the right to vote.

→ WATCH

Learn more about Nellie McClung and her quest to get the vote for women.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Nellie McClung

WEEK 9 **25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 9** *Election Day*

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading about starting an



Term 1

	election campaign? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.36-43 "Even though it's so easy" - "late into the evenings." (Audiobook: Chapter 8) • Describe some of the activities that take place on election day.	
WEEK 10	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 10 <i>Election Day, cont.</i> Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway? → RECAP What do you remember from last week's reading about Election Day? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.44-47 "Both you and Nathan" - "who elected them." (Audiobook: Chapter 9) → WATCH 1. Learn more about how MPs are elected and what happens to Parliament after an election. ∞ Video Link: How do elections affect Canada's Parliament? 2. Learn more about majority and minority governments. ∞ Video Link: What are majority and minority governments? 3. Learn more about what the term "Responsible Government" means. ∞ Video Link: What is responsible government?	
WEEK 11	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 11 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings. You can also work on updating your Timeline, Book of Centuries, or Citizenship Notebook. You can also explore various Canadian symbols that can be found at Parliament. ∞ Link: Canadian Symbols at Parliament	
WEEK 12	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 12 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?	



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 13

Touring Ottawa

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading about Election Day?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-51 "Finally, you're in Ottawa!" - "stand guard at the National War Memorial." (Audiobook: Chapter 10)

→ WATCH

1. The main Parliament building in Ottawa, known as Centre Block, is currently closed for renovations. Take a tour of the current House of Commons at West Block.
∞ Video Link: Explore the House of Commons at West Block
2. Take a tour of the Senate's temporary home in an unexpected place!
∞ Video Link: Explore the Senate of Canada Building
3. Tour the Library of Parliament.
∞ Video Link: Celebrating the Library of Parliament
4. Tour the Memorial Chamber in the Peace Tower (currently closed for renovations), where the Books of Remembrance are held.
∞ Video Link: Centre Block's Memorial Chamber
5. You can search for names and view individual pages digitally of the Books of Remembrance.
∞ Link: Books of Remembrance

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 14

Current Events - Government

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 15

A New Session of Parliament

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from your tour of Parliament Hill?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-55 "Whether it's your first day" - "even asked to leave." (Audiobook: Chapter 11)

→ ACTIVITY

1. Test your knowledge of the steps involved in holding a federal election in Canada.
∞ Link: Parliament and Elections
2. Test your knowledge of the roles various MPs and other individuals play in the House of Commons.
∞ Link: Parliament at Work: House of Commons



Term 2

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 16

Current Events - Government

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 17

A Day in the House of Commons

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the opening of a new session of Parliament?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-62 "A session of Parliament" - "back up your proposal." (Audiobook: Chapter 12-Chapter 13, ending at 5:24)

→ NOTEBOOK

What does a typical day at the House of Commons look like? Add some notes to your Citizenship Notebook about today's reading, or a reading from a previous week.

WEEK 6 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 18

Current Events - Government

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 7 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 19

Other Proceedings

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember about a typical day in the House of Commons?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-65 "One of the most important" - "(No kibble required)." (Audiobook: Chapter 13 5:25-end)

→ ACTIVITY

The public is an important part of our system of government. What are some of the rights and responsibilities that individuals have in Canada? Test your knowledge in the activity below.

∞ Link: Rights and Responsibilities in the Community

WEEK 8 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 20

Current Events - Government

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen



Term 2

article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 9 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 21

A Bill Becomes Law

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember about a typical day in the House of Commons?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.66-70 "A bill is a proposal" - "the bill has become a law." (Audiobook: Chapter 14 0:00-8:21)

→ ACTIVITY

Test your knowledge of how a bill becomes a law with this game. You can play through several times as a different Parliamentarian and with different bills.

∞ Link: Bill on the Hill

WEEK 10 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 22

Current Events - Government

Materials: Calendar of Events

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 11 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 23

Wrap Up

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about how a bill becomes a law?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-74 "Nunavut and the Northwest Territories" - "See you on Parliament Hill!" (Audiobook: Chapter 14 8:22-Chapter 15)

→ NOTEBOOK

Add some notes to your Citizenship Notebook about today's reading, or a reading from a previous week.

WEEK 12 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Who Runs This Country, Anyway?



Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 25

Introduction to Three Levels of Government

 Materials: Citizenship Notebook

→ INTRO

This term, you will learn more about the three levels of government for your own area. This will require independent online research, so be sure to consult with your parent or teacher.

→ REFLECT

Before looking anything up, can you name the three levels of government? Do you remember the titles of the heads of each level, and do you know the names of the individuals who fill these roles in your local area?

→ NOTEBOOK

Divide a blank page into three columns, and label each with the name of each level of government. Using the links below, enter as much information as you can regarding the structure and responsibilities of each.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Levels of Government (Video)

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Levels of Government

→ EXPLORE

Test your knowledge with the following activities. If you run out of time today, you can test your knowledge during the next lesson.

∞ Link: Activity: Levels of Government

∞ Link: Around Town Game: Levels of Government

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 26

Federal Government

 Materials: Citizenship Notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Canada is divided into electoral districts, each one represented by a Member of Parliament (MP). These districts are also called ridings or constituencies. Because these areas are determined by population rather than area, some can be geographically very large while others are smaller.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Today, you are going to do some research about your local federal electoral district. By using the resources below, and through additional research with help from your parent or teacher, see if you can answer the following questions:

- How many electoral districts are there in Canada?
- What is the name of your local electoral district?
- Can you find a map of it?
- Who is your MP?
- What party do they belong to?
- Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?
- What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?
- Can you find out more information about your MP from their own website?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Who are parliamentarians?

∞ Link: Home Page for the 2025 Federal Election



Term 3

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 27

A Tour of Parliament

Materials: Citizenship Notebook

→ INTRO

While the Centre Block is currently closed for renovation, this video offers a glimpse of what the interior of the Centre Block is like. According to the description, "this immersive journey takes you deep into the heart of Parliament, where an iconic building surges to life with magic realism. Animals spring from stone walls. Empty rooms echo with the voices of the past. And figures who have helped shape Canada return to take their place in the halls of democracy."

→ VIEW

First, take a look at this map to see where the various buildings on Parliament Hill are located.

∞ Map Link: Map of Parliament Hill

Next, watch the video, which is approximately 15 minutes long.

∞ Video Link: Parliament: The Virtual Reality Experience

→ NOTEBOOK

Add some notes to your Citizenship Notebook about today's reading, or a reading from a previous week.

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 28

Current Events - Government

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about the federal government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or written.

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 29

Provincial Government

Materials: Citizenship Notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Each province and territory has a legislative assembly, forming the provincial level of government. Each province and territory is divided into electoral districts with a representative to the legislative assembly from each district. The boundaries of your provincial electoral district may differ from the federal ones. The provincial representatives have different titles in different provinces/territories (e.g., Member of Provincial Parliament (MPP) in Ontario, Members of the National Assembly (MNA) in Quebec, Members of the House of Assembly (MHA) in Newfoundland and Labrador, and Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLA) in most other places). The leader of the party with the most seats becomes the Premier. Each province also has a Lieutenant Governor who, like the Governor General, is the representative of the King of Canada for each province and territory.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Today, you are going to do some research about your local provincial electoral district. By using the resources below, and through additional research with help from your parent or teacher, see if you can answer the following questions:

- Who is the Premier of your province/territory and what is their political party?
- What is the name of your local provincial electoral district?
- Can you find a map of it?



Term 3

- Who is your representative, and what title do they have in your province/territory?
- What party do they belong to?
- When was the most recent election?
- Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?
- What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?
- Can you find out more information about your representative from their own website?
- Who is your Lieutenant Governor and how long have they served in this role?

→ VIEW

Find the Elections website for your home province or territory (use search terms "election" and name of province/territory)

WEEK 6 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 30

Current Events - Government

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your provincial or territorial government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or written.

WEEK 7 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 31

Local Government

 Materials: Citizenship Notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Today, you will look at local government. Local governments are a paradox, because we most often forget that they exist, while they often have the most direct impact on our daily lives.

→ READ & DISCUSS

The head of the municipal government is usually called a mayor, but may have a different title in some places. Your municipality might be the same as your city, or, for smaller towns and rural areas, the municipality might be made up of several communities or a wider area. With the help of a parent or teacher, look up the website for your municipality and try to answer the following questions:

- What is the name of your municipality?
- Can you find a map of it?
- Who is the mayor (or other title) of your municipality?
- What other representatives make up your local government and what are their titles?
- When was the most recent election?
- Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?
- What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?
- Can you find out more information about your mayor from their own website?

WEEK 8 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 32

Current Events - Government

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your local municipal government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or written.



Term 3

WEEK 9 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 33

Write a Letter

Materials: Citizenship Notebook, envelope & postage (opt.)

→ INTRO

Today, you are going to write a letter to one of your elected officials. Whether or not you decide to send the letter is up to you.

→ WRITE

Brainstorm some issues that are important to you, or ask yourself what one thing you would like to improve about where you live. Do some research about the issue: what needs to change? What has been done about it in the past? Then think about what level of government oversees that area. You can return to the activities from Lesson 25 if you need a refresher. Your local representative for that level of government is the recipient of your letter.

WEEK 10 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 34

Understanding Parliament

→ INTRO

Spend today's lesson exploring further topics about Parliament that interest you. Feel free to do one or both options.

→ EXPLORE

Option 1: Explore how Parliament works at this website.

∞ Link: Understanding Parliament

Option 2: Watch an excerpt from a recent House of Commons or Senate Proceedings or Question Period.

∞ Video Link: House of Commons Video Archive

∞ Video Link: Senate Video Archive

WEEK 11 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 35

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings. You can also continue to explore the resources from the previous lessons, or work on updating your Timeline, Book of Centuries, or Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Canadian Government: Grade 7

Examination

- Term 1** · Explain at least two changes that occurred with the Constitution Act of 1982 OR Describe the steps involved from calling an election to the tallying of votes on election day.
- Term 2** · Describe some or all of the following spaces at Parliament Hill: the House of Commons, the Senate, the Memorial Chamber, and/or the Library of Parliament. Consider aspects such as: how the space is used, its design and notable features, its history, etc. OR Explain the process of how a bill becomes a law.
- Term 3** · Explain what the three levels of government are, including what services and issues each of them oversees OR describe one of the articles you read this term.